



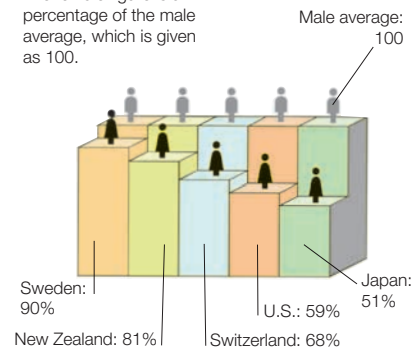
## SOCIAL POVERTY

In most countries, there are groups of people who are poorer than others. Women are usually poorer than men – they are often paid less (see chart right) or are housewives with no income. Also, women often have a lower standard of education, which means they are not qualified to obtain higher-paid jobs. Single mothers and elderly single women are particularly at risk from poverty. Older people on low pensions and the sick are also poorer than average. In some places, such as São Paulo in Brazil (shown left), children are forced to live on the streets because they have no families to support them or homes to live in. They often beg or turn to crime to survive.

*Favelas (slums) in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, stand next to luxurious apartment buildings.*

## Male and female wages

The female figure is a percentage of the male average, which is given as 100.



## WOMEN'S EQUALITY

In September 1893, New Zealand became the first country in the world to give women the right to vote. This marked the beginning of a long, worldwide struggle by women in many countries for equal rights in all aspects of life, including education, divorce, and equal opportunities at work.

## THE NEWLY RICH

Historically, the wealthy countries of the world have been in Europe and North America. With the discovery of oil reserves in the Middle East in the past 60 years, the desert states of the Arabian Peninsula are now among the richest nations in the world. Also, the spectacular growth of Asian economies, such as Hong Kong, Taiwan, South Korea, and China – which have all followed in the footsteps of Japan – means that these countries may soon join the world's wealthiest nations.



*Oil wealth has helped Dubai grow from a small trading post 50 years ago to a rich city with modern buildings.*

## EQUAL WEALTH DISTRIBUTION

Some countries strive for a more equal distribution of wealth among their citizens, so that there are few, if any, very rich or very poor people. Their governments spend a large proportion of national wealth on education, health care, social welfare, and job creation to help all levels of society. New Zealand was the first country in the world to introduce a full welfare state, while Scandinavian countries, such as Sweden, concentrate on providing jobs for everyone. Today, they are among the most equal societies in the world.



*The Big Issue is one of 35 street papers sold round the world by the homeless, with proceeds from sales going to help the homeless.*

## DIFFERENCES IN WEALTH

Within many countries there are great differences in income between rich and poor. In Europe and North America there are many homeless people on the streets or seeking refuge in cardboard shelters. In some poor countries, such as India, rich landowners and industrial managers flourish. In Brazil, the poorest 10 percent of the people earn only 0.7 percent of the total income, while the richest 10 percent earn 48 percent, a difference of 68 times. In comparison, the poorest 10 percent in Hungary earn 4.1 percent, while the richest 10 percent earn 20.5 percent, a difference of only 5 times.

## INTERNATIONAL AID

In order to help the world's poorest countries, the richer nations give them aid in the form of grants, loans, or, when a natural disaster such as an earthquake occurs, food, tents, and clothing. Some African countries, such as

Mozambique, are dependent on aid for much of their income. The largest source of aid is the U.S., which provides more than \$13.3 billion a year, although this is only 0.13 percent of its Gross National Product (GNP).



*Rodeo Drive, Beverly Hills, is one of the richest shopping streets in the world.*